

## Charging from your feet

An entrepreneur in Kenya has developed tech that charges mobile/ipod devices while walking or running  
<http://dgit.in/JLYtYF>

## No Skype for Lumia 610

Nokia said that the quality of performance is not upto the par with the company and Skype's expectations

# Sony Vaio S-series

## A lot of potential, but some things need to be set right first

**T**he dark chocolate brown color with the glossy finish will make you either check out your reflection and/or make you wince in exasperation. Open the lid of the Sony Vaio S, and you now see a different shade of brown, almost bordering on Golden!

Not surprisingly, the Vaio doesn't feel as quick as you'd think – Sony preloads the machine with a bunch of crapware, mostly its own applications. Even when using Windows like you would on a day-to-day basis, it feels slow.

During the testing process, the preloaded Windows on the Vaio crashed. But horror of hor-

rors – the restore discs installed a 32-bit version, though this laptop comes with a 64-bit OS preloaded! All the slowdown issues cleared



up when we did a clean installation of Windows on the machine.

The 13.3-inch display (WXGA++ 1600x900 pixels) is an absolute delight – matte finish is a welcome change from the reflective ones we've seen on laptops. The brightness

is impressive, but could have done with a bit more depth to the black levels.

Battery life turned out to be a huge disappointment. On the dedicated graphics (Speed), the battery ran out of juice in 58 minutes. We tested the battery life with the on-board graphics (Stamina mode) and it ran out completely in 1 hours and 26 minutes.

The Vaio S-series (VPCSA35GG/T) has a combination of good performance and build plus a very slim form factor – everything seems right for it, potentially. However, the low battery life and high price could be an issue for some potential buyers.

*Visbal Mathur*

## Specifications

**Processor:** Intel Core i7-2640M @ 2.8GHz; **RAM:** 6GB; **Display:** 13.3-inch (1600x900 pixels); **Graphics:** AMD Radeon HD 6630M / Intel HD 3000; **Storage:** 750GB HDD; **Optical drive:** Yes

## Contact

**Sony India**  
**Phone:** 1800-103-7799  
**Price:** ₹ 79,990

6.5  
10

Features .....8.0  
 Performance.....7.0  
 Build Quality .....7.5  
 Value for Money .....6.0

# Huawei Honor

## Indications for the future are bright

## Specifications

**Platform:** Android 2.3;  
**Processor:** 1.4GHz Scorpion,  
 512MB RAM; **Display:** 4 inches,  
 480 x 854 pixels; **Storage:**  
 1GB, microSD slot and 16GB  
 cloud; **Camera:** 8MP with 720p  
 videos; **Battery:** 1930mAh

## Contact

**Huawei Telecommunication**  
**India Ltd**  
**Phone:** 1800-209-6555  
**Email:** service.hw.in@  
 huawei.com  
**Price:** ₹19,990

6.5  
10

Features .....7.0  
 Performance.....6.5  
 Build quality .....6.0  
 Value for money .....6.0

**L**ying on the desk, it looks like a typical mid-range Android smartphone. Powering the Honour is the 1.54GHz single-core processor, with 512 MB of RAM. The performance is adequate, and there'll be no stutter or hiccups as you go along. Even with a single-core processor, we were surprised at some of the good benchmark scores – Honour stands up to the likes of the Sony Xperia S and the HTC Sensation.

The 4-inch display has a basic resolution of 480x854 pixels. The colours are subdued, and could have done with a bit more depth as far as black levels are concerned. However, the text on the display is very

crisp, which helps with reading.

This 8MP camera will do decently well if the ambient lighting is good. There's a lot of shutter lag when taking shots in low light or at night. However, the images either have considerable smearing (probably due to the processing that is adamant on reducing edge noise) or a generous amount of motion blur in low lighting.

Decent battery life from the 1930mAh battery, with about



a day and a half of backup time under normal usage conditions.

On paper, this has a very capable hardware package. A promised Android ICS update is only as good as it not being here at the moment! You can consider a lot more options around this price

bracket – slightly higher and slightly lower. But if this is the way Huawei is going, expect some real rocking phones from it this year.

*Visbal Mathur*